

Homes Around Hertel

Residential context and field investigation

Prepared 8 October 2026 | Companion to the 48-property parcel map

Executive Summary

- The same rectangle contains roughly 2.4k residential parcels, accounting for 80.2% of selected parcels. This is an industrial corridor embedded in a large residential fabric. Mixed-use buildings are counted separately. [P1]
- Two-family homes account for 50.8% of residential parcels and one-family homes 41.2%. Apartment buildings are only 3.3% of parcels, but a building can contain many dwellings. Parcel shares cannot establish how many people rent or where most residents live. [P1]
- 80.3% of the 2,279 valid construction-year records predate 1940; 78 residential parcels have missing/out-of-range years. Older housing raises useful questions about maintenance and accessibility but does not establish poor condition or a health hazard. [P1]
- The city's published 2024 indicators show greater renter, poverty and no-vehicle percentages in Grant-Amherst and West Hertel than in North Park and Parkside. Their aggregation and margins of error are unavailable, so use them as interview context, not precise block-level estimates. [R1-R2]

Four neighborhood contexts, several different street experiences

The city parcel data place this rectangle chiefly in West Hertel, Grant-Amherst, North Park and Parkside. Neighborhood labels and common use of 'Black Rock' do not create one shared demographic boundary. The published neighborhood metrics apply to broader areas, while the housing counts apply only to the rectangle. [P1, R1-R2]

West Hertel / the western edge. Start with the home blocks around Military, Race, Lawn, Page and Hinman, then compare the frontage approaching Hertel and Botsford. Test how residents use the retail and job corridor and where curb cuts, loading or crossings affect their routes.

Grant-Amherst / Chandler's residential edge. Examine the nearby blocks around Grote, Germain, Peter, Howell and Bush. Interview people whose daily paths meet industrial doors, vacant lots and reused buildings. Compare daytime production with evening event activity instead of describing Chandler only as a nightlife destination.

North Park / north and east of the corridor. Use the residential streets toward Delaware and Avery, including the Tennyson/Homer/Virgil/Lovering area shown in the original image. Follow actual paths to Hertel, shops and bus stops. Broad neighborhood indicators cannot tell you the circumstances of a particular household.

Parkside / the southeastern context. Compare streets around Delham and Chatham and the route toward Amherst/Delaware. Record the physical transition from large sites and traffic corridors to smaller

residential lots. Use the city's neighborhood polygons to check a precise boundary before assigning a quoted block to a neighborhood.

These are reporting transects, not surveyed neighborhood borders or a claim that every named street lies wholly inside one neighborhood.



Projected parcel geometry from the city service. Colors show tax land-use categories, not current occupancy. The rectangle matches the earlier map; street/index reference is available in that companion map. Map displays parcels crossing the edge; counts use centroid selection. [P1]

The housing stock is dominated by one- and two-family properties

The roll identifies 1,198 two-family parcels, 972 one-family parcels, 78 apartment parcels, 53 multiple-residence parcels, 52 three-family parcels and four residential-with-commercial parcels within the Residential category. The table below preserves the full denominator of 2,357 residential parcels. [P1]

Two-family buildings can accommodate an owner and a renter, multiple renting households or other arrangements. Tax class does not tell us tenure, lease terms, occupancy or legal unit count today. Likewise, a single large apartment parcel may house more people than dozens of one-family parcels. Do not call this table a dwelling-unit census.

For interviews, sample both house types and apartment buildings. Ask renters about the lease, rent changes, repairs and landlord contact. Ask owners about insurance, heating, maintenance and property taxes. Ask both groups how nearby employment, shops and industrial activity enter their daily lives.

Residential tax class	Parcels	Share
Three Family Dwelling	52	2.2%
Two Family Dwelling	1198	50.8%
One Family Dwelling	972	41.2%
Apartment	78	3.3%
Multiple Residences	53	2.2%
Residence With Commercial Use	4	0.2%

Old construction is widespread; condition must be observed separately

Of the 2,357 residential parcels, 2,279 have a recorded year greater than 1800 and no later than 2026. Among those valid records, 1,830 predate 1940, or 80.3%; the median recorded year is 1920. The 78 missing/out-of-range records are excluded from that age percentage and shown separately in the table. [P1]

The year field may reflect a principal structure and does not capture every addition, replacement or rehabilitation. An old building can be maintained and efficient; a newer building can have defects. These data do not identify lead paint, asbestos, energy burden, disability access or indoor air quality.

On the walk, note steps, sidewalk-to-door access, obvious exterior repairs, roof work and posted renovation permits. Ask residents which repairs are costly, whether heating bills have changed and whether assistance reached them. Keep any health assertion tied to appropriate records or qualified measurement, not a visual judgment.

Recorded construction year	Parcels
Before 1940	1830
1940 or later	449
Missing / outside valid range	78

Published indicators suggest different pressures around the same corridor

The city's Neighborhood Metrics 2024 table reports renter percentages of 82.8% in Grant-Amherst, 63.4% in West Hertel, 55.3% in North Park and 53.0% in Parkside. Its poverty indicators are 36.2%, 38.7%, 9.5% and 7.2% respectively; no-vehicle indicators are 32.5%, 18.2%, 13.0% and 11.7%. These are the published values, not independently recomputed census estimates. [R1]

The pattern supports testing whether repair costs, rent changes and difficult crossings matter differently to different residents. The no-vehicle figures make walking and transit access particularly relevant interview topics on the western side. They do not establish that industry caused poverty, that a given household has no car, or that a specific block faces displacement.

Material data limitation: BURA describes the dataset as compiled from 2024 ACS. The public metadata does not explain aggregation or supply margins of error; some population and income fields contain fractional values consistent with aggregation rather than simple neighborhood totals. We therefore omit those population and income fields, do not combine neighborhoods, and do not assign their percentages to the smaller study rectangle. Direct Census API retrieval did not return usable data in this run. The rates below should be treated as indicative city-published context pending tract/block-group validation.

City neighborhood	Renter	Poverty	No vehicle	Vacant units
Grant-Amherst	82.8%	36.2%	32.5%	10.1%
West Hertel	63.4%	38.7%	18.2%	6.7%
North Park	55.3%	9.5%	13.0%	8.7%
Parkside	53.0%	7.2%	11.7%	9.4%

Percentages reproduced as published by BURA; broader geography, unknown aggregation and no margins of error. Do not combine these rates or apply them to individual blocks. [R1]

Schools, healthcare and transit anchor everyday routes

West Hertel Academy (PS94) publishes its address as 489 Hertel and serves PK-8. School-route reporting should examine the public approaches and crossings; current school contact is 716-816-4150. Ask adult caregivers or school leadership about walking, drop-off and traffic conflicts. Do not photograph identifiable children for this investigation without appropriate consent. [R5]

Evergreen Health at 800 Hertel, suite 100, publishes primary and pediatric care, pharmacy and other services. Public phone: 716-847-2441. Ask the organization about transit access, appointment travel and building accessibility; ask patients only with their voluntary consent. Its location is relevant to access, not evidence of illness caused by nearby industry. [R6]

NFTA's current schedule listing includes 20 Elmwood, 23 Fillmore-Hertel, 25 Delaware and 32 Amherst. Inspect stop placement, shelter, lighting and crossing distances at the actual stops used by residents. Use the current route pages for the date of the walk; the report does not assert a specific headway or that every route enters the entire rectangle. [R4]

Black Rock Riverside Neighborhood Housing Services appears in the state's neighborhood housing organization directory. It is a useful interview contact about repair assistance, counseling and housing needs. Ask what its present service geography and eligibility are rather than assuming every property qualifies. [R7]

River Rock Connections is the city's connectivity planning process involving neighborhood, business and transit stakeholders. It gives a useful frame for walking/bicycle/transit questions. Ask which proposals were funded, built or delayed; the existence of a plan is not evidence that its improvements are complete. [R3]

A residential investigation that can distinguish experience from assumption

Housing costs and stability. Interview renters, owners and small landlords separately. Ask for the last two lease renewals or actual tax/insurance bills where voluntarily provided. Compare the same property's costs over time; online asking rents alone cannot establish displacement. For property transfers, record date, SBL, transaction type and price, excluding non-market transfers from a sale-price comparison.

Access to jobs and services. Ask residents where they work, how they get there and whether nearby employers recruit locally. Ask for a specific route to groceries, school, healthcare and transit. A factory beside homes does not by itself establish that neighbors receive its jobs.

Noise, freight and daily timing. Record the location, date, duration and character of what you hear or see. Ask whether that episode is typical and seek a second observation. Compare residents near loading doors with residents one or two streets away. Short observations cannot establish an annual nuisance pattern or legal limit exceedance.

Reuse and neighborhood change. Ask longstanding residents and newcomers what changed when Chandler properties were reused. Interview businesses that left as well as those still present. Compare building permits, occupied space and lease histories before treating an attractive new venue as neighborhood-wide revitalization.

A fair sample. Cover at least two blocks in each reporting transect, different times of day, renters and owners, and people who walk, drive and use transit. A target of 12-20 adult interviews is a practical field plan, not a statistical sample. Record refusals and avoid calling a few interviews representative of everyone. Offer interpretation or translated questions when requested rather than inferring language from appearance.

Two walks and a repeatable observation sheet

Walk A - jobs, homes and the western approaches. Start at the public Hertel/Military intersection, examine the public frontage near PS94, continue east on Hertel, then compare residential approaches toward Page/Lawn/Race and the public Botsford/Norris frontage. Finish at Hertel/Elmwood near the healthcare site. Adapt to signed crossings and actual sidewalk conditions; this is an itinerary, not a verified uninterrupted pedestrian route.

Walk B - reuse and the eastern housing edge. Start at Hertel/Elmwood, follow public sidewalks toward Chandler, examine public frontages at the numbered properties, then compare routes toward Amherst/Delaware and the nearby residential streets. Do not use the rail corridor, industrial yards or an unmarked lot as a shortcut. Private interiors require permission.

Repeat one section during a weekday production period and one during an evening/weekend service period. Allow separate time for interviews and rechecking locations. Record date, start/end time, weather, exact crossing/doorway, map number if applicable, photo ID, observation versus interview statement, and a follow-up document needed.

For each crossing: signal or marked crossing; sidewalk continuity; curb ramp; sight line; obstruction; truck movement during a fixed interval; bus stop access. For each housing block: principal house types; visible renovations; posted permits; voluntary resident account; and what remains unknown. Avoid

recording residents' names or private details in a public evidence table without consent.

Records that would make the residential story stronger

Request existing city building/code/311 records for residential SBLs within the rectangle, 2020 through 8 October 2026, including type, date, status, resolution and location. An unresolved complaint is not a verified violation, and a raw complaint count depends on reporting behavior. Remove personal contact information from any published dataset.

Obtain permit and demolition histories to distinguish renovation from loss of housing. Use assessor unit fields cautiously and reconcile with occupancy records before estimating dwelling units. Obtain deed records and a consistent time series before claiming prices or ownership concentration changed.

For demographics, validate ACS five-year tract/block-group tables with margins of error and a documented crosswalk to the neighborhood polygons. Useful topics are tenure, rent burden, income, poverty, household vehicles and commuting. Keep tract statistics distinct from the rectangle when boundaries do not align.

For traffic/access, ask city public works and NFTA for existing crossing audits, traffic counts, crash data, stop changes and accessibility projects. Match the same period and geography before comparisons. There is no verified crash-rate, eviction-rate, rent-growth or neighborhood disease analysis in this report.

For housing assistance, interview the relevant organizations about actual applications, approvals, repairs completed and unmet demand in the study area. City-wide funding announcements cannot be counted as benefits delivered to these blocks without project-level evidence.

Methods and limits

Parcel analysis uses the same signed-area centroid selection as Report 1: 2,939 parcels within the rectangle from 3,126 intersecting city features. Residential means the exact city LandUse label, which excludes separately coded mixed use. Class shares use 2,357 residential parcels as denominator; construction-age shares use only 2,279 valid recorded years. No parcel count is converted into people, households, rental units or occupied homes. [P1]

Neighborhood percentages are reproduced from the 35-row BURA Neighborhood Metrics 2024 file, retaining four named rows and multiplying fractional indicators by 100. Their boundaries extend outside the parcel rectangle. Aggregation methods and sampling uncertainty were unavailable, so they are not independently validated estimates for this walk. [R1-R2]

The report uses no individual resident ownership list, speculative income inference, unsourced crime ranking or company-caused health claim. No site visits or interviews have been completed. It supplies a documented starting point and concrete questions for original reporting, rather than a conclusion about residents' lives based on land-use colors.

Sources and retrieval notes

Bracketed source IDs in the text refer to the clickable entries below. All web sources were checked on 8 October 2026; original document dates remain stated. Company statements are attributed rather than audited.

P1. [City of Buffalo 2026-2027 parcels](#)

Parcel addresses, owners, tax classes, geometry and construction years; downloaded 8 October 2026.

E1. [DEC: 1803 Elmwood proposed remedy, April 2026](#)

C915394 scope, occupancy and proposal; not evidence the remedy has been completed.

E2. [DEC: C915356 executed agreement, September 2020](#)

Explicitly links 100 Botsford site name to 96 Botsford street address.

E3. [DEC: C915356 citizen participation plan, 2020](#)

Former lumber/CCA wood-treatment history; historical source, not latest completion status.

E4. [DEC: 166 Chandler periodic review, May 2022](#)

Reports 2018 restricted-use brownfield cleanup; does not replace newest certification.

E5. [EPA: Universal Precision historical response](#)

215 Chandler, August 2010 assessment; profile says response activities concluded. Historical conditions are not current exposure findings.

R1. [BURA Neighborhood Metrics 2024](#)

City-published ACS-derived neighborhood indicators; aggregation details and margins of error unavailable.

R2. [Open Data Buffalo Neighborhood Profile](#)

City neighborhood framework and demographics context.

R3. [River Rock Connections](#)

City connectivity planning process, stakeholders and pedestrian/bicycle/transit priorities; no completion claim.

R4. [NFTA route schedules](#)

Current listed routes 20 Elmwood, 23 Fillmore-Hertel, 25 Delaware, 32 Amherst; verify stop-level schedules for field date.

R5. [West Hertel Academy](#)

PS94, 489 Hertel, PK-8 and school contact.

R6. [Evergreen Health, 800 Hertel](#)

Clinic, pediatric/primary care and pharmacy at suite 100; public contact.

R7. [Black Rock Riverside Neighborhood Housing Services](#)

State-listed neighborhood housing organization for interview/resource referral.